AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
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SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

+27 76 757 5773
www.africansolidaritycivic.org

CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Pick n Pay × ASCO

Community Food Resilience and Low-Waste Action Hubs

Requested CSI investment: R50,000

Proposed implementation area: South Africa; select one clearly defined community close to an identified ASCO implementation partner and, if appropriate, a Pick n Pay operating footprint after the company confirms geographic fit.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Pick n Pay** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Community Food Resilience and Low-Waste Action Hubs**. The proposed request is **R50,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Community Food Resilience and Low-Waste Action Hubs in South Africa; select one clearly defined community close to an identified ASCO implementation partner and, if appropriate, a Pick n Pay operating footprint after the company confirms geographic fit., benefiting Proposed: food-insecure households, children and caregivers, and community-garden participants in the selected South African community, with priority to vulnerable households identified through transparent local referral criteria. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Pick n Pay's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R50,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Community Food Resilience and Low-Waste Action Hubs

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
South Africa; select one clearly defined community close to an identified ASCO implementation partner and, if appropriate, a Pick n Pay operating footprint after the company confirms geographic fit.

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: food-insecure households, children and caregivers, and community-garden participants in the selected South African community, with priority to vulnerable households identified through transparent local referral criteria.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: support or establish 1 community food-resilience hub and document a baseline, implementation plan and beneficiary register.
- Proposed: reach 100 food-insecure households with a combination of food-support, nutrition/community-resilience activities and referrals.
- Proposed: train 30 community members in food gardening, nutrition, basic resource efficiency and safe food handling.
- Proposed: establish or strengthen 1 community food garden and track harvest/use or distribution records.
- Proposed: run 2 community waste-reduction or clean-up actions and record participants and material collected/diverted.
- Proposed: submit a short outcome report with receipts, attendance, safeguarding evidence, photos/consent and environmental/food-resilience indicators.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the

specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Pick n Pay?

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

Verified company context

- Pick n Pay states that its CSI strategy focuses on long-term partnerships that empower communities through education, food security, small-business support and job creation.
- Its stated CSI focus areas include education and awareness, hunger, and health and wellbeing; its wider ESG framework includes supporting communities, sustainable supply chains and reducing environmental impacts.
- Pick n Pay identifies affordable, healthy, safe and responsibly sourced food, inclusive supply chains and reduced food waste as priorities.
- Environmental focus areas include reducing carbon footprint, conserving freshwater, reducing and repurposing waste, and addressing packaging; the Group also reports energy, water, waste and refrigeration priorities.
- The FY25 Integrated Annual Report reports more than 180,000 meals distributed through Feed the Nation, 1,401 tonnes of food donated to FoodForward SA, 182 community food-garden initiatives supporting more than 11,000 families, 64% general-waste diversion from landfill, and 1.8 tonnes collected in nationwide beach and community clean-ups.
- The Group operates across South Africa and other southern African markets shown in the report; the cited CSI and community examples are primarily framed around South African communities.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R30,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R4,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R3,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R4,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R3,500	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R3,500	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R2,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R50,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R50,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Submit through Pick n Pay's official Donations Request Form: https://forms.office.com/Pages/ResponsePage.aspx?id=Re6M4LNVjEeonYr5hsuM82bF_6sRfK9CufuqxMUpgppUMTlUTzFNUDBPTDZTT08wNEROOVZGSllGNS4u and copy or follow up with donations@pnp.co.za. The official investor contact page also lists the registered office telephone +27 21 658 1000. No separate public CSI eligibility policy was found in the reviewed sources.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- Pick n Pay's public materials do not establish that this specific proposal will be funded, that ASCO is eligible, or that a R50,000 grant is within an approved budget.
- No public source reviewed specifies geographic quotas, beneficiary eligibility rules, grant size limits, closing dates, reporting templates or environmental-project exclusions for the donations route.
- The reported programme figures are Pick n Pay/Group-reported results and should not be represented as ASCO results or as a promise of equivalent future support.
- Confirm whether Pick n Pay requires registration documents, governance checks, safeguarding policies, budgets, monitoring indicators, tax documentation, or a partner/referral organisation before submission.
- Do not claim Section 18A approval, completed ASCO results, an existing Pick n Pay relationship, or any company commitment.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Pick n Pay** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.picknpayinvestor.co.za/our-commitment.php
2. https://www.picknpayinvestor.co.za/pdf/annual-report/2025/integrated-annual-report-2025-spread.pdf
3. https://www.pnp.co.za/feed-the-nation
4. https://www.picknpayinvestor.co.za/contact-us.php
5. https://www.picknpay.co.za/sustainability

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.